

# FURMAN BANDS CONSTITUTION

## PREAMBLE

No organization has ever achieved real success without the full cooperation of all its members. This is certainly true of an organization such as a band. The members must unite and work in accord toward a definite goal--that being to have a superior performing ensemble. This being true, there must be rules to serve as guideposts for this development in order that the band can grow systematically, effectively, and with a minimum of friction. Each member should pledge their full cooperation and work with the officers and the directors for the development of the best possible musical organization.

## ARTICLES

**I. Elections:** During the spring term, between mid-term and final exams, elections of officers to serve for the next school year shall be held; a process which normally takes several rehearsal periods. The Executive Council will meet one week prior to the open-floor nominations and compile a tentative slate of nominees. This slate will serve as the officers' recommendations to the band. The current President and Secretary will then take nominations from the floor beginning with the office of President and continuing until all positions have been filled. The Band Secretaries will be responsible for tabulating the ballots for the annual officer elections. A ballot of candidates will be compiled and presented to the band for votes to be cast. A simple majority of members present (51%) is the minimum required to elect someone to a position.

The officers to be elected are: President, Vice-President, Secretary, Social Co-Chairs, Publicity Co-Chairs, Alumni Secretary, Historian Co-Chairs, and SGA Representative. Freshmen Representatives are to be elected by the freshmen class at the end of Band Camp. The drum major is to be considered an officer, however, this person is selected through an audition; this is an entirely different and separate process from the officer elections, as are other marching band leadership positions.

**II. Executive Council:** The Executive Council consists of the President, Vice-President, Secretary, and the Drum Majors. This group meets with the directors when necessary, as arranged by the President. This body of officers exists for the purpose of keeping communications open between the directors and band members.

**III. Leadership Meeting Procedure:** The President is to arrange all leadership meetings, scheduling them as needed. The leadership consists of all elected officers and section leaders. Each leadership member is expected to attend all meetings unless previously excused by the president. Any more than two unexcused absences will result in the student being removed from

a leadership position. Meetings shall be conducted in a format promoting open discussion, and those items affecting the entire band will be voted upon. A majority vote will be required for these items to pass. All band members are encouraged to attend the leadership meetings, although they will not vote.

#### **IV. Offices**

A. **PRESIDENT:** The president must have been active in the band for at least one year and one semester prior to their election. The president shall serve as the chair for the Band's leadership meetings. They will preside at leadership meetings and elections, and will stay in close communication with each of the officers lending any needed assistance or guidance. They will assist the Vice-President with all financial matters. They will also stay in close contact with the faculty to insure good communication between the staff and the Band students. It is the President's responsibility to represent the Band in the Furman community and on the music student's advisory council.

B. **VICE-PRESIDENT:** The Vice-President must have been active in the Band for at least one year and one semester prior to their election. The Vice-President assumes the duties of the President if the President must be absent from an officers' meeting, officiates over the finances of the Furman University Band account, and assigns the Big Sibling list for the year in which they has been elected to serve.

C. **SECRETARY:** The Secretary must have been in the Band for at least one semester prior to their election. The Secretary is to record the minutes at all officers' and executive council meetings, as well as handle written communications to band members. The Secretary will also be responsible for keeping attendance records for rehearsals and performances.

D. **SOCIAL CO-CHAIRS:** The Social Co-Chairs will consist of two people, who must have participated in the Furman Band program for at least one full year prior to elections, including a season of marching band. They shall organize daily band camp activities, the freshman welcome party, the Family Weekend picnic, concert receptions, the fall banquet, and the spring banquet. Any other activities planned by these people to promote social interaction among the band members will be encouraged.

E. **PUBLICITY CO-CHAIRS:** The Publicity Co-Chairs will consist of two people, who have participated in the Furman Band program for at least one full year. The Publicity Chairs will be expected to advertise the performances of the Furman Band (via signs, posters, public announcements, electronic media, etc.) so that the Furman student body and the Greenville community are aware of the band's activities. The Publicity Co-Chairs are also responsible for working with a faculty/directing staff member on producing the press-packets for home game

performances. The Publicity Co-Chairs will be responsible for setting up tables and displays for the activities fair, scholarship auditions, and visitation days. They will also be responsible for setting up Furman Band merchandise for sale at concerts, inventory of merchandise, and organize the storage of merchandise and publicity materials.

F. ALUMNI SECRETARY: The Alumni Secretary will be responsible for maintaining a list of all past Furman Band members, and their locations if possible. This person must have participated in the Furman Band program for at least one full year. They will be responsible for the distribution of communications to alumni in the form of a monthly blog on the Furman Bands Website as well as any other special mailings that need to be distributed. The Alumni Secretary should consult the Furman University Alumni Office regularly.

H. SGA REPRESENTATIVE: The SGA Representative is the Band's delegate to the Student Government Association, the student government organization of Furman University. This officer must be in attendance at all SGA meetings that deal with matters that might pertain to the Band.

I. DRUM MAJORS: The drum majors will serve as the student conductors of the Band. In addition to his/her work with the Marching Band, they will conduct the Basketball Band and will organize any special performances of the Band members for the purpose of supporting the University or obtaining funds (see by-laws).

J. MARCHING BAND LEADERSHIP: Marching Band Leadership shall consist of the drum major(s), auxiliary captains, section leaders, freshman representatives, and other positions deemed necessary by the Band director and Band staff. These are appointed positions that serve a one-year term. The responsibilities of the Marching Band leadership positions should be listed in the by-laws.

K. HISTORIANS: The Historians will consist of two people, who have participated in the Furman Band program for at least one full year. They will be asked to compile, arrange, and organize all pictures and publicity with regards to the Furman Band Program in the form of a scrapbook. They will also produce a video montage for presentation at the Fall and Spring Banquet. The Fall Banquet will focus on the Marching Band and the Spring Banquet will highlight all facets of the program. In addition, they will help the Alumni and Band Secretaries in the updating the Furman Band's Web Page. The Publicity Co-Chairs will assist in this project.

L. FRESHMAN CLASS REPRESENTATIVES: One male and one female will be elected by the Band members in the freshman class at the conclusion of Band Camp to represent them at leadership meetings. These people will contribute their ideas and concerns for the Band

at leadership meetings. They will be the first people contacted by any officers who need assistance.

## **V. Amendments**

Amendments to the Band constitution may be made by two-thirds majority of the enrollment of the Band.

## **VI. Distribution of Band Constitution, Bylaws, and Calendar**

All new and returning Band members shall receive an electronic copy (PDF Format) of the Furman Band Constitution, Bylaws, and Calendar during Band Camp each fall.

# **BYLAWS**

## **I. MEMBERSHIP**

Membership in the Furman Band is open to all students enrolled at Furman University. Students from Greenville Tech may also participate with special permission. Furman students are required to register for band, but there is no tuition charge and no credit awarded. All participating students are expected to pay a \$30.00 band registration fee at band registration that will be used to cover the cost of the two Band Banquets, purchase of a required band T-shirt, baseball cap, homecoming expenditures, and other miscellaneous expenses.

## **II. MATERIALS**

A. UNIFORMS: Each member of the Band will be issued a uniform at the beginning of the year.

The uniforms will be stored in the uniform storage area in the music building for the duration of the season. Shakos, gloves, and shoes will remain in the possession of the band member for the duration of the season. Failure to return a uniform following a performance may result in an adjustment of the grade for the course. Band members are also liable for damages to the uniform that are the result of improper care or carelessness. Appropriate charges will be assessed and collected.

1. The uniform will be worn correctly when in public view.
2. The shako will be carried in the left hand when not being worn.

3. The trousers should be adjusted with the included snaps so the crease breaks one time.

4. Gloves should be clean and shoes should be shined.

5. It is unacceptable to wear sunglasses when the shako is being worn.

6. The Band t-shirt of the current year should be worn under the tunic.

#### B. UNIFORM COMMITTEE AND PROCEDURES:

The Uniform Committee will consist of a chairperson and four other individuals, one of whom may be a representative from the work crew:

1. The number assigned to an individual will be the number of his/her tunic.

2. The uniforms should be stored in garment bags with the number of the tunic on the name card. After assignment of uniforms, a card with the band member's name, tunic, trouser, and shako number will be inserted for the duration of the season.

3. When uniforms need to air out, the garment bag will be left unzipped at check-in.

4. Any member returning the uniform without the garment bag will be assumed to have not turned in the uniform and will face the consequences stated in the constitution.

5. Possible assignment process:

a. Four stations (trouser, tunic, shako, contract) should be created.

b. Two to three band members can move through each station at once, aided in finding a uniform by a committee member. If all stations are full, only eight to twelve band members will be in the uniform assignment area at any given time.

c. Proceeding through the stations in the above order, the band member will arrive at the contact station with a full uniform, where a committee member will create the individual name card, obtain a signed contract, and record the assigned parts on the master roster, before the bag is hung on the mobile racks in numerical order.

d. While this means the wait for uniform fitting is longer outside the "dungeon," the chaos and wait inside the fitting area will be reduced so that an

accurate record of all parts is obtained and the storage of the newly assigned uniforms remains organized

6. Possible check-out/in process

a. Four uniform committee members will be present at each of the four mobile racks during check-out/in.

b. These members will have a roster of numbers and corresponding names for their specific rack (ex: Rack #1: Uniforms 100-125; Rack #2: Uniforms 126-150, etc.) The roster will also include the member's phone information and check-in/out columns:

| Name | Uniform Number | Cell | Check Out | Check In |
|------|----------------|------|-----------|----------|
|------|----------------|------|-----------|----------|

|          |     |              |  |  |
|----------|-----|--------------|--|--|
| John Doe | 101 | 555-555-5555 |  |  |
|----------|-----|--------------|--|--|

c. The committee member will be responsible for ensuring the bags are checked out to the correct individual and recorded as such on the roster

d. Names corresponding to bags that are not checked out (excluding those absent for the day) will be phoned

e. Members will be responsible for checking out/in these bags within time-frames after morning rehearsals/performances

f. A fifth uniform committee member will oversee the distribution of gauntlets.

g. Plumes will be distributed at Ellis Field or the performance venue

h. Check in will work in reverse:

i. Band members go to the rack which contains their number

ii. Committee member checks the uniform in on the roster, ensures it is hung properly, and that the garment bags are placed in numerical order on the rack

iii. Members with unreturned uniforms at the end of the time frame will be phoned. Members with unreturned uniforms will be

emailed once before the beginning of the next week and if not returned before the next marching band rehearsal, publicly humiliated at said rehearsal

iv. Committee member #5 will supervise the return of gauntlets into the correct storage bins

v. A work crew/leadership member will be responsible for the distribution and receiving of plumes

C. MUSIC ASSIGNMENT: The librarian shall distribute Music to each person. Each person is expected to be responsible for said music and will return it upon request of the librarian. Failure to return music and/or pay for lost or damaged music may result in an adjustment of the grade for the course. The lost folder replacement cost is \$5.00 with individual parts costing \$.50.

D. INSTRUMENTS: Each bandsman will be responsible for his/her own instrument, and may make use of the lockers in Daniel Hall. These lockers may be secured from the music office for a \$10.00 refundable deposit during band camp. Students who do not own personal instruments will be issued one by the property manager. The student will be entirely responsible for the university-owned instrument. Failure to return the instrument may result in an adjustment of the grade for the course.

E. MISC.: Marching band students are also expected to provide the following: black shoes, black socks, white gloves, flip folder, lyre, and marking utensil (pencil). Flutes and percussion are generally expected to have music memorized, and therefore should not need lyres.

### **III. ATTENDANCE**

Students are expected to attend all rehearsals and performances of the Furman University Band. Excused absences from performances will be allowed for appropriate reasons; legitimate curricular conflicts, illness, death in the family, emergencies, or other conflicts previously cleared with the Director. Courtesy dictates that the Director be informed at least two weeks in advance of a performance for an absence to be considered excused. Procrastination regarding study or homework will not constitute an excused absence.

A. Roll will be taken promptly at the beginning of each rehearsal. Section leaders will note absences and tardies, and report to the Secretary. The Secretary will maintain an

accurate roll book and report information to the director. A tardy of 30 minutes or more may count as an unexcused absence.

B. For any absence or tardy from a rehearsal, a student must obtain clearance from the director at least twenty-four (24) hours before the rehearsal in question in order for it to be considered excused. Failure to do so will result in the absence or tardy being considered unexcused. The Director retains the right to determine the validity of each request.

C. It is the section leader's responsibility to investigate attendance problems when necessary.

D. A band member with one unexcused absence from a rehearsal during a game week will not be allowed to perform during halftime of that game. Two unexcused absences from rehearsals or one unexcused absence from a performance will result in the band member receiving a grade of unsatisfactory and possible dismissal from the band.

E. Four unexcused tardies will equal one unexcused absence.

F. Any extra rehearsals will be announced one week in advance. If one-week notice is not given, the rehearsal is not subject to the above policies.

G. A schedule of planned rehearsals and performances will be published at the beginning of each semester so that each member can plan accordingly.

H. End-of-season awards are based upon participation within stated attendance guidelines.

#### **IV. DISCIPLINE**

A. The conduct of bandsmen during rehearsals, during performances, and anywhere you are representing the Furman Band, is expected to be of the highest standards.

B. Rehearsals: There is much to be accomplished in a short time, so take your horn, warm up, and wait quietly for the director.

C. Ellis Field: It is very important that conversation and idle chatter be kept to a minimum during this time due to the fact that so little time is provided to put together a show. Much work must be accomplished while on the field, so instructions must be given with no interference.

D. Being under the influence of alcohol or controlled substances during band activities is forbidden. Please refer to the substance abuse policy in the current edition of "The Helmsman." Students who violate this policy will be referred to the appropriate University officials.

E. This is the ideal scenario: THERE ARE NO DISCIPLINE PROBLEMS IN THE FURMAN BAND; THE BAND MEMBERS WILL NOT ALLOW IT.

**V. MARCHING BAND LEADERSHIP:** All applicants for appointed leadership positions are required to have an interview with the Director of Bands as a part of the selection process.

A. DRUM MAJOR: The Drum Majors are selected through a competitive audition held each spring semester. The Drum Major will perform an audition for the membership and selected faculty members for evaluation. The audition will consist of conducting the Band on the Alma Mater, a composition performed by memory, and an interview with the Director of Bands. The membership of the Band has the right of a confidence vote, which is weighed very heavily in the final decision. Returning Drum Majors always have to re-audition for their position.

This officer is responsible for all aspects of on-field direction of the proper rehearsal procedures (starting on time, restarting drill sequences, not accepting poor performance, etc.). The Drum Majors will function as the spirit leader of the band. No office or position carries more responsibility.

B. AUXILIARY CAPTAINS (see respective constitutions)

1. FURMAN DANCE COMPANY: The Dance Company Captains are selected by the Director and the FDC sponsor through an audition and interview process. There must be an advisory vote taken by the current membership to indicate confidence level to the director. The Captains are responsible for the appropriate conduct and deployment of this valuable auxiliary group and shall work with the Director to insure smooth function through the marching season.

2. COLORGUARD: The Colorguard Captain(s) is selected by the Director through an audition and interview process. There must be an advisory vote taken by the current membership to indicate confidence level to the Director. This person(s) shall work with the Director to coordinate all activities of the ensemble and shall otherwise function as a section leader. NOTE: In lieu of other sponsorship, the Director shall function as school sponsor for both the Dance Team and the Colorguard.

C. SECTION LEADERS: The Section Leaders run the Marching Band in essence. They are responsible for the following:

1. Attendance of their section at all functions.
2. The musical preparedness of their section.
3. Teaching drill to their section.
4. Developing section pride and spirit.
5. Developing innovative cheers and spirit-boosting activities for football games.
6. Implement a music organization and flip folder standard to be used by his/her section.
7. Ensure that each member of his/her section has music needed at each rehearsal/performance.
8. Keep extra copies of necessary music on hand.

The band director selects section Leaders through an interview process. It is noted that the most crucial link in the chain of leadership in The Paladin Regiment is in **the hands of the SECTION LEADERS!**

## **VI. BANQUETS AND AWARDS**

### **A. FALL MARCHING BAND BANQUET**

Each fall, at the conclusion of the marching season, there will be a banquet for all participants in the Marching Band. At this banquet, awards for the marching season will be given. These awards include: Best Section, Most Spirited Section, Outstanding New Marching Band Member, Drumline Awards, and Auxiliary Awards. This banquet is free for all Marching Band members.

### **B. SPRING AWARDS BANQUET**

There will be a Spring Awards Banquet for all those who participate in the concert bands and Furman University (no cost). During this banquet, major awards will be presented, and the next year's Marching Band leadership and officers announced.

C. AWARDS: There are several traditional awards presented by the Furman Band Program. Titles and qualifications are as follows:

1. Vince Perone Outstanding Bandsman: Band members vote, any band member in good standing is qualified. The recipient's name will be engraved on a plaque displayed in the rehearsal hall and he/she will receive a trophy.
2. Dan A. Ellis Outstanding Freshman: Band members vote, any freshman band member in good standing is qualified. The recipient's name will be engraved on a plaque displayed in the rehearsal hall, and he/she will receive a trophy.
3. Jake Rasor Outstanding Senior Bandsman: Band members vote, any senior band member in good standing is qualified. The recipient's name will be engraved on a plaque displayed in the rehearsal hall, and he/she will receive a trophy.
4. Junior Bandsman Award: Each junior or senior band member who completes 6 consecutive semesters of band participation in good standing or any auxiliary member who has completed four years of marching band will receive a gift in appreciation of their service. Exceptions for consecutive enrollment in band are made for foreign study and other possible school-related interruptions.
5. Senior Bandsman Award: Each senior band member who completes band participation in good standing will receive a framed certificate of participation in appreciation for his or her service. Each senior band member who completes 8 consecutive semesters of band participation in good standing will receive, in addition to the certificate, a special award. Exceptions for consecutive enrollment in band are made for foreign study and other possible school-related interruptions.
6. John C. Carmichael Award: This award is chosen by the Band Director and will be presented to a student who consistently makes a great contribution to the Furman Band Program, but does not always receive the recognition that they deserve.

## **VII. MISCELLANEOUS**

A. ORIENTATION: Students will be able attend all important orientation meetings that are scheduled through the week of band camp. We do not want you to miss anything important to your future success at Furman. We have arranged our rehearsals so that you can attend Band and fully participate in Orientation activities. Your task is to attend the meetings you must attend and to be at the band rehearsal scheduled for that day. If in doubt as to whether a particular orientation meeting is important, ask your section leader,

big sibling, or a staff person. Just be sure to keep your section leader informed as to where you are and what you are doing.

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B. RAIN POLICY: In case of light to moderate rain, report to the field wearing appropriate rain gear. Woodwind instruments remain in their cases. In case of heavy rain and/or lightning, report to field area but remain in cars. Do NOT stand under trees! When a decision is made as to the status of rehearsal, staff members will circulate with instructions. Always report to the field for all scheduled drill session. If a session must be postponed or canceled, we will get word to you at that time.

C. PARKING AT THE BAND FIELD: Parking for cars at the band field will be in the parking lots adjacent to Ellis Field. Please do not park on the sidewalks.

D. STUDENT CONDUCTOR: The band director may select student conductors, based upon their work in the Instrumental Conducting Course and the Advanced Conducting Seminar, who will be responsible for preparing a selection with the Symphonic Band during the Fall and/or Spring Semester. These students should be a junior or senior and must have successfully completed Instrumental Conducting (Mus 353).